Media Collaboration - Video Series & News Partnerships

Media Collaboration: Video Series & News Partnerships

Stemming from the Commission Research Intelligence Dashboard

Overview

The Commission Research Intelligence Dashboard gives us a unique position in the Madlanga Commission media landscape. We have structured, cross-referenced data that no newsroom has — every entity mention, every witness connection, every timeline organized and searchable. This is the raw material for compelling, data-driven journalism and documentary content.

This document outlines how to package that capability into media partnerships and a direct-to-audience content operation.

Asset: What We Bring

Asset	Description	Competitor Advantage
Structured data	Every entity, witness, and document cross-referenced across 147+ hearing days	No newsroom has this — they work from transcripts and memory
Network analysis	Who said what about whom, visualized	Enables data-driven stories other outlets cannot produce
Search & retrieval	Find any connection in seconds	Speed of story development — first to break cross-referenced stories
Institutional knowledge	Deep understanding of the commission record	Can provide expert commentary, not just reporting
Dashboard technology	The tool itself is a story — "how we tracked everything"	Unique behind-the-scenes content angle

---

Partnership Model 1: SABC News (Public Broadcaster)

Format

12-part documentary series, 26–52 minutes per episode, broadcast on SABC 2 or SABC 3.

Value to SABC

- Commission coverage fulfills their public mandate
- Pre-packaged, researched storylines — minimal production lead time
- Exclusive access to data-driven insights no other broadcaster has
- High public interest — commission has been front-page news for a year

Value to Us

- Broadcast reach (millions of viewers)
- Production budget (SABC commissions content from independent producers)
- Credibility and brand association with a national broadcaster
- Payment: R50,000 – R150,000 per episode (independent producer rates for SABC) = **R600,000 – R1,800,000 for 12 episodes**

Our Role

- Research & story development (using the dashboard)
- Episode scripting and narrative design
- On-screen analyst / presenter (optional)
- Fact-checking and source verification

SABC's Role

- Production facilities (cameras, studio, editing)
- Broadcast scheduling and promotion
- Compliance and editorial oversight

Approach

1. Develop a **sizzle reel** (3–5 min teaser using commission footage + our analysis)
2. Pitch to SABC **Commissioning Editor — Documentaries**
3. Alternatively, approach through an independent production company with SABC relationships

---

Partnership Model 2: Daily Maverick (Digital Investigative Journalism)

Format

Ongoing investigative journalism partnership — articles, interactive features, and data-driven exclusives published on Daily Maverick's platform.

Value to Daily Maverick

- Exclusive data-driven stories their journalists cannot replicate
- Interactive web features (embedded network graphs, entity browsers) — increases time-on-site and subscriptions
- First access to your analysis — competitive advantage in commission coverage
- Daily Maverick already covers the commission extensively (they sued over in-camera hearings)

Value to Us

- Editorial platform with 500,000+ monthly readers
- Reputation by association (Daily Maverick is award-winning investigative journalism)
- Potential for a recurring column or "Data Watch" segment
- Payment: R5,000 – R15,000 per feature article = **R60,000 – R180,000 for 12 features** (or retainer model)

Our Role

- Propose data-driven story angles
- Provide research, entity analysis, and network visualizations
- Write or co-author articles
- Build interactive web features using dashboard data

Daily Maverick's Role

- Editorial review and publication
- Promotion across their channels
- Payment for content

Approach

1. Contact **Daily Maverick Investigations Desk** or editors who covered the commission's in-camera lawsuit
2. Pitch 3–5 specific story angles with sample data from the dashboard
3. Offer an exclusive first article as a demonstration

Partnership Model 3: YouTube Channel (Direct-to-Consumer)

Format

Self-published 12-episode video series, 15–30 minutes per episode, uploaded weekly.

Cost Structure

Item	Estimated Cost
Basic production (screen recording + voiceover)	R0 – R5,000 total
Mid-tier (scripted, edited with b-roll and motion graphics)	R15,000 – R30,000 total
Full production (studio, presenter, professional editing)	R50,000 – R150,000 total

Revenue Potential

Source	Estimate for 12-episode series
YouTube ad revenue (10k–50k views/episode)	R5,000 – R30,000
Sponsorship / brand deal	R20,000 – R100,000
YouTube memberships / Super Chat	R5,000 – R20,000
Total	**R30,000 – R150,000**

Approach

1. Start lean — screen recording + voiceover using the dashboard as visual reference
2. Each episode demonstrates a specific finding from the dashboard
3. Build audience over the first 4 episodes, then introduce higher production value
4. Use episodes as portfolio to pitch SABC / Daily Maverick

Episode 1: The Story Arc

This is the expanded version of the original 12-episode concept, now structured as a narrative arc that builds across the series.

Act 1: The Whistleblower

Ep	Title	Hook	Data Angle
1	**"The Whistleblower Who Shook the Police"**	Lt-Gen Mkhwanazi's July 2025 press conference — one man vs the system	Network graph showing Mkhwanazi's connections to every subsequent witness
2	**"The Politicians in the Shadows"**	Senzo Mchunu's interference, Vusi Shongwe's R10M bribe allegation	Entity browser tracing political interference across the record

Act 2: The Criminal Enterprise

Ep	Title	Hook	Data Angle
3	**"Meet 'Cat' Matlala — The Crime Boss Who Owned the Cops"**	Vusimuzi Matlala's infiltration of SAPS	Network graph of Matlala's connections to police, politicians, and business
4	**"The R360 Million Tender Heist"**	Medicare 24 contract — how a criminal won a police tender	Timeline of tender process vs Matlala's criminal cases
5	**"The KZN Hawks — Protectors or Predators?"**	Maj-Gen Senona leaking info to Matlala	Evidence compare — what Hawks said vs what witnesses said

Act 3: The Cartels

Ep	Title	Hook	Data Angle
6	**"The Big Five Cartel"**	Gauteng syndicate infiltrating law enforcement	Story map showing how cartel connections span multiple witnesses
7	**"The Indian Cabal Inside SAPS"**	Feroz Khan, Carnilinx, and the R10M bribe	Entity browser tracing the Khan-Sayed-Malema-Malema connections
8	**"The Aeroton Cocaine Bust That Wasn't"**	How a 715kg coke bust went wrong — was the informer a trafficker?	Evidence compare — what official reports say vs what witnesses say

Act 4: The Cost

Ep	Title	Hook	Data Angle
9	**"They Were Killed for the Truth"**	Witness D (Marius van der Merwe) and Jaco Hanekom assassinations	Timeline connecting their testimony to their deaths
10	**"The Closed-Door Scandal"**	Media lawsuits against the commission for in-camera testimony	Entity browser — what was heard in secret

Act 5: The Future

Ep	Title	Hook	Data Angle
11	**"The Cartel's Weak Link"**	Witnesses who flipped — who turned and why	Network graph showing which witnesses named the most entities
12	**"What Happens After Madlanga?"**	Referrals, prosecutions, and reform	Summary of all prima facie findings across the record

---

Target Audience

Platform	Primary Audience	Secondary Audience
SABC	General South African public (35+)	Rural and township viewers
Daily Maverick	Urban, educated, politically engaged	Investigative journalism community
YouTube	South Africans 18–35	International audience interested in SA politics
Podcast	Commuters, professionals	Academic / researcher community

---

Timeline

Phase	Timeline	Activity
Phase 1: Pilot	Aug 2026	Produce Episodes 1–2 (lean production, YouTube). Build audience and portfolio.
Phase 2: Pitch	Sep 2026	Approach SABC and Daily Maverick with pilot episodes as proof of concept.
Phase 3: Partnership	Oct–Dec 2026	If SABC deal closes — produce remaining 10 episodes on production budget. If not — continue self-publishing on YouTube.
Phase 4: Expansion	Jan 2027+	Continue as ongoing series if commission extensions or follow-up investigations occur.

Revenue Projections

Conservative (YouTube-only, no partnerships)

Source	Estimate
YouTube ad revenue (12 episodes)	R10,000 – R40,000
Sponsorship (1–2 brand deals)	R10,000 – R30,000
Total	**R20,000 – R70,000**

Moderate (Daily Maverick partnership)

Source	Estimate
Feature articles (12 × R8,000)	R96,000
YouTube ad revenue	R10,000 – R30,000
Sponsorship	R10,000 – R30,000
Total	**R116,000 – R156,000**

Optimistic (SABC documentary series)

Source	Estimate
SABC production budget (12 × R100,000)	R1,200,000
Daily Maverick articles (8 × R8,000)	R64,000
YouTube clips / behind-the-scenes	R10,000 – R20,000
Total	**R1,274,000 – R1,284,000**

Next Steps

Action	Owner	Timeline
1. Record Episode 1 using dashboard screen capture + voiceover	Content team	1–2 weeks
2. Upload to YouTube, promote on X/Twitter and LinkedIn	Marketing	After recording
3. Reach out to Daily Maverick investigations editor	Business dev	After Episode 1–2 published
4. Research SABC commissioning editor contacts	Business dev	Ongoing
5. Develop sizzle reel for SABC pitch	Content team	After 4 episodes

---

Contact Notes: Daily Maverick

Daily Maverick has been one of the most active media outlets covering the Madlanga Commission. They: - Sued the commission over in-camera hearings (October 2025) - Have dedicated commission coverage with reporters like Rebecca Davis and Caryn Dolley - Publish daily “Follow live” updates during hearings - Have a large, engaged subscriber base interested in investigative journalism

Suggested approach: Email their investigations editor or the reporters who covered the commission directly. Reference specific stories they’ve published and offer exclusive data-driven angles your dashboard enables that they cannot get elsewhere.

Contact Notes: SABC News

SABC News has a public mandate to cover the commission. They: - Broadcast daily live coverage of hearings - Have a dedicated news team for the commission - Commission documentaries through their Content Hub / Commissioning Editor

Suggested approach: Find the SABC Commissioning Editor for Documentaries. Pitch the series as fulfilling SABC's public mandate — an in-depth, data-driven account of the most important commission since Zondo.

This document is a business development plan for the Commission Research Intelligence Dashboard project. Revenue figures are estimates based on South African media industry rates and should be refined through direct engagement with partners.